PRODUCTBEACON RESEARCH · WEM RADAR

Salesforce prices its contact centre for Europe. The personal-agent standard goes public as a draft.

Weekly summary · 18 October 2026

By Yohay Etsion · former NICE product leader (Recording/WFO), 2008–2021 · public sources only · full disclosure on the last slide

SALESFORCE IN EUROPE

Salesforce said its own contact centre would go live in Europe on 16 October.

- Salesforce said this on 13 October, for “30+ European countries including the UK”, with Australia and New Zealand to follow in November.
- Its global price page lists the base product at £100 or €125 per user a month. The version with workforce engagement management costs £200 or €250.
- The workforce management add-on now has a price in every listed currency. It costs £40 or $50 per user a month.
- The UK and EU versions of the price page still showed no local prices on 18 October.

> Our view: Salesforce now competes for contact-centre seats in Europe. Human staff pay per seat, while its customer-facing AI is billed on credits. Watch: local prices on the UK and EU pages.

SOURCES Salesforce, 13 Oct · Salesforce price page, 18 Oct

THE DEAL TALK

Business Insider reports Decagon is testing a sale. ServiceNow denies any interest.

- Business Insider reported on 13 October that Decagon hired a bank to test buyer interest. The report is unconfirmed, and Decagon did not comment.
- It said Decagon held early talks with ServiceNow and others. ServiceNow's president, Amit Zavery, told PYMNTS it has "no interest or intention" of buying Decagon.
- Business Insider then updated its story to say ServiceNow is no longer in talks. It says Decagon could raise a new funding round if no deal happens.
- PYMNTS notes Decagon raised $250 million at a $4.5 billion valuation in January.

> Our view: Salesforce bought Fin last month. A sale of Decagon would leave buyers with fewer large independent AI customer-service vendors. Watch: a named buyer, a signed deal or a new funding round.

SOURCES Business Insider, 13 Oct · PYMNTS, 13 Oct

THE STANDARD

The personal-agent standard led by Sierra and Meta goes public as a draft.

- Sierra and Meta launched the Personal Agent Protocol on 6 October. On 14 October it became a public GitHub project, labelled draft 0.1.
- The draft makes every message say whether a person or an AI agent wrote it. A personal agent can ask for a person; if no one is available, the request goes back to idle.
- Lorikeet switched on support on 12 October. Zendesk announced a public list of verified support contacts for AI assistants, and Parloa says it is building middleware for personal agents.
- The design-partner list names Genesys, Sierra and Zendesk among its technology providers. Salesforce and Microsoft are not on it.

> Our view: the draft writes a request for a human into the standard. Contact centres should expect personal agents that ask for a person on purpose. Watch: a tagged release, and whether Salesforce joins.

SOURCES Personal Agent Protocol, draft 0.1 · GitHub, 14 Oct · Lorikeet, 12 Oct · Zendesk, 13 Oct · Parloa, 15 Oct

THE CLAIMED RATES

xAI says about 70% of Starlink's calls are resolved with no human. Fin now says 76%.

- xAI says Starlink's call centres answer 20,000 calls a day with its Grok Voice model. "Roughly 70% are resolved with no human in the loop."
- The figure is the supplier's own claim. xAI does not define "resolved" or give a repeat-call rate. Its list price is $0.08 a minute.
- Fin now says its average resolution rate across all customers is 76%. The same Fin page gave 67% last week, with early-stage teams at 76%.
- The page's dates still read 9 October. Fin says it now serves 12,000+ businesses, up from 8,000+.

> Our view: this is a claimed figure for a whole support line rather than a pilot. We cite 76% as Fin's own claim; the lower figure was removed without explanation.

SOURCES xAI, 14 Oct · Fin learning page, dated 9 Oct

THE SCHEDULE

As far as we can tell, no tracked vendor yet changes live schedules by itself when demand shifts.

- Lorikeet's own comparison table, checked 8 October, says intraday scheduling is "next, not live at launch". We found no later dated post, release note or price.
- Microsoft added contact-centre workforce management items to its public roadmap on 16 October, the first we have seen there. Its two October intraday features alert supervisors and report staffing against forecast.
- Cisne, now on Five9's marketplace, says it models the contacts that bots handle. Its intraday tool is "recommending schedule adjustments".
- Aspect says its February release included rule-based automatic schedule edits. Its automatic intraday correction is marked "Coming Soon".
- Clarification: last week we called Lorikeet's offer the first in our coverage to change the live schedule by itself. That holds only for changes driven by live demand, not for rule-based edits.

> Our view: software that changes the schedule by itself when live demand shifts is still a promise among the vendors we track. Edits triggered by customer-set rules already exist. Watch: Microsoft's October intraday features.

SOURCES Lorikeet, 8 Oct · Microsoft roadmap, 16 Oct · Cisne, 13 Oct · Aspect, 26 Feb

THE AGENTS

Agent assist turns into agents that act, at Cresta and Five9.

- Cresta launched Deputy Agent on 13 October. Cresta says it keeps working on refunds, disputes and insurance-claim appeals for days or weeks after the call.
- Cresta says business rules decide which actions wait for review. It gave no price or availability date, and its two named customers speak of “an opportunity” and excitement, not results.
- Five9 regrouped its product menu in the week of its customer event, its website shows. AI agents and live help for human agents now sit side by side.
- A Five9-commissioned survey of 3,000 consumers says trust in AI rises from 26% to 55% when a human option is reachable.

> Our view: both vendors now present help for human agents and autonomous AI as parts of one product.

SOURCES Cresta, 13 Oct · Five9 platform page, 15 Oct · Five9, 14 Oct

THE RULES

California’s emotion-AI ban reaches staff call scoring, lawyers say.

- Zaller Law says the ban comes up in sales and customer service teams that “record calls or video meetings, then grade the representative.” It starts on 1 January 2027.
- It says scoring a customer’s sentiment “is a different question” from scoring the employee’s tone, which is what triggers the ban.
- CDF Labor Law advises employers to disable or replace emotion-reading features before year-end. We found no contact-centre vendor renaming, limiting or switching off an emotion or sentiment feature for California.
- In the UK, techUK, the technology trade body, says the proposed monitoring definition captures “scheduling, workforce planning”. It asks for guidance instead of new duties.

> Our view: in California, quality and coaching tools that score both the customer’s sentiment and the agent’s tone are exposed. Watch: Colorado’s hearing on its revised draft rules on 26 October.

SOURCES Zaller Law, 17 Oct · CDF Labor Law, 16 Oct · techUK, 13 Oct · Colorado, 8 Oct

THE OUTSOURCERS

Outsourcers face pressure while some still grow.

- Foundever, with about 130,000 staff, named Pierre Barrial, formerly chief executive of IDEMIA, as chief executive. He says the company can “accelerate AI deployment”.
- Conduent’s lenders extended part of its credit line to 30 October while they finalise a refinancing, it filed. The filing does not mention AI.
- TELUS Digital became an implementation partner for Parloa’s AI agents. Clients contract with Parloa for the platform and with TELUS Digital for services.
- Against: TP, formerly Teleperformance, is opening its 29th Philippine site, which it expects to create more than 1,000 jobs. Indian outsourcer Fusion CX’s share sale was 4.68 times subscribed.

> Our view: the strain on outsourcers is uneven. Indebted firms are restructuring around AI while others still add seats and raise money.

SOURCES Foundever, 13 Oct · Conduent, 15 Oct · TELUS Digital, 14 Oct · Outsource Accelerator, 13 Oct · Chittorgarh, 16 Oct

SOURCES

Sources behind this week's news.

Company announcements, official records and reporting cited on these slides:

COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Salesforce · Fin · Sierra · Meta · GitHub · Personal Agent Protocol · Lorikeet · xAI · Zendesk · Parloa · Microsoft · Cisne · Aspect · Cresta · Five9 · Foundever · TELUS Digital

OFFICIAL RECORDS, FILINGS AND TRADE BODIES

techUK · Colorado (Attorney General) · Conduent (SEC filing)

PRESS REPORTING AND LEGAL ANALYSIS

Business Insider · PYMNTS · Zaller Law · CDF Labor Law · Outsource Accelerator · Chittorgarh

Source links are in the full weekly summary. Full claim-by-claim citations on request.

FULL DISCLOSURE

Salesforce lists European prices. The personal-agent standard is now a public draft.

Salesforce said its contact centre would go live in Europe on 16 October. Business Insider reports that Decagon is testing a sale, which is unconfirmed; ServiceNow denies interest. Our view: software that changes live schedules by itself when demand shifts is still a promise among the vendors we track.

→ Read the full report

productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wem-2026

> The author was employed by NICE from 9 April 2008 to 20 May 2021, including senior product-leadership responsibility for the Recording / Workforce-Optimization line of business, and remains bound by a confidentiality and trade-secret undertaking from that employment. The report relies solely on published material and contains no information derived from that employment. NICE is graded on the identical published-material rubric applied to every peer, no softer, no harsher, and was held under an adversarial cross-chapter read in both directions. The author holds no NICE equity and has no current commercial relationship with NICE.

Independent research. Public sources and vendors' own words. Interpretations are labelled as ours. Not investment advice.